Schrödinger's cat

Voiceover script · about 63 seconds · 192 words · read at about 3 words per second

Chapter 1 - The box (0:00)

Physics, please. What is this quantum physics nonsense? A physicist invented a cat that's alive and dead at once. He wasn't bragging. He was complaining. A cat sits in a sealed box next to an atom with a fifty-fifty chance of decaying. But if it decays, a Geiger counter trips a hammer, the poison flask breaks, and the cat's evening gets worse.

Chapter 2 - Alive and dead? (0:20)

Then the quantum part. Until it's measured, the atom is described as a mix of decayed and not decayed. The atom is linked to the cat. On paper, the cat is alive and dead until someone looks. Relax. It's a thought experiment. It was never actually done. You see, Schrödinger invented it in 1935 to criticise the theory. If it says this about a cat, something's wrong.

Chapter 3 - Decoherence (0:42)

Today's leading explanation is decoherence. A cat is trillions of particles, always bumping into air and light. Every bump acts like a tiny measurement, so the quantum weirdness leaks away almost instantly. So a real cat is alive or dead. The box just hides which. Physicists still argue about the rest. The cat was never about cats. It was a complaint about physics.